

D718

Student Teaching II in Elementary Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

On a two-digit subtraction quiz, most wrong answers in a second-grade class look like $52 - 17 = 45$. The quiz was on a Friday before a field trip to the zoo, and the class has a new aide. What is the most likely misconception?

- A. Adding instead of subtracting.
- B. Careless errors from excitement about the trip.
- C. Not knowing basic facts.
- D. Subtracting the smaller digit from the larger in each place instead of regrouping.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher knows most students misapply regrouping in subtraction. What is the best reteaching plan?

- A. Move on to multiplication.
- B. Reteach regrouping with base-ten blocks and have students explain when to trade a ten.
- C. Give more subtraction worksheets.
- D. Reteach the whole unit from the start.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A third-grade class is studying persuasive writing. The school is near a park where the swings were removed, and the class loves a popular cartoon. Which activity offers the most relevance?

- A. A worksheet decorated with cartoon characters.
- B. Students write letters to the city parks department asking for the swings to be replaced.
- C. A persuasive essay on a textbook prompt.
- D. Letters that are never sent, graded for spelling only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A fourth grader who arrived from another country last year speaks conversational English but struggles to write science explanations. Her family owns a bakery, and she sits by the window. What support fits best?

- A. Have her write about baking.
- B. Provide sentence frames such as “The ___ changed because ___,” a word bank, and partner talk first.
- C. Assign an easier science topic.
- D. Let her draw instead of writing, all year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

During state testing, a student teacher sees her cooperating teacher point to a correct answer for a struggling student. The cooperating teacher has been kind and wrote her a strong letter of recommendation. The test was in the library. What should the student teacher do?

- A. Confront the teacher in front of the class.
- B. Change the student’s answers back herself.
- C. Follow the school’s testing policy and report the incident to the proper person, such as the university supervisor or test coordinator.
- D. Say nothing because of the recommendation letter.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher is asked by a parent to change a grade the student did not earn, and the parent is on the school board. What principle decides the response?

- A. Grades must accurately reflect student work, regardless of who asks.
- B. Change it if the parent is very upset.
- C. Board members may request grade changes.
- D. Always refuse to discuss grades with parents.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A student teacher in her last month has been grading until midnight, skipping meals, and feels constantly tired. Her placement is at a large school with a new gym. What is the healthiest next step?

- A. Stop grading work altogether.
- B. Push through, since good teachers work every night.
- C. Join the new gym and change nothing else.
- D. Set a work cutoff time, streamline grading, and talk with her supervisor or a support resource.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A new teacher’s evaluation shows strong planning but low marks for questioning. She teaches third grade and loves gardening. Which growth goal is best?

- A. “I will start a class garden.”
- B. “I will become a better teacher.”
- C. “By March, I will ask at least three higher-level questions per lesson, tracked by weekly self-recording and one peer visit.”
- D. “I will improve my planning.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher’s goal says: “Increase student discussion time.” What must be added to make it measurable?

- A. A target amount and a date, such as “to 30% of class time by May, recorded weekly.”
- B. A reason why discussion matters.
- C. The word “greatly.”
- D. Nothing; it is already measurable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A student teacher learns about a new digital reading program at a conference and wants to replace all reading instruction with it tomorrow. The program has great reviews online and a bright logo. What is the wisest approach?

- A.** Replace all instruction now based on reviews.
- B.** Never try new programs.
- C.** Try it with one group for a few weeks, compare results with a clear measure, then decide.
- D.** Try it with the whole class with no measure.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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11.

On an evaluation rubric, the top level for discussion says: “Students ask one another questions and build on each other’s ideas.” In a lesson in a room with a new rug, the student teacher asked every question and students answered her only. She worked very hard on the lesson. Which level is best supported?

- A.** The lowest level, since any teacher questioning fails.
- B.** The top level, because students answered every question.
- C.** The top level, because she worked hard.
- D.** A level below the top, since students did not build on one another’s ideas.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to reach the top rubric level for discussion. Which change would provide that evidence?

- A.** Structure talk so students question and respond to each other.
- B.** Call on every student once per lesson.
- C.** Write longer lesson plans.
- D.** Ask more questions herself.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

On a two-digit subtraction quiz, most wrong answers in a second-grade class look like $52 - 17 = 45$. ~~The quiz was on a Friday before a field trip to the zoo, and the class has a new aide.~~ What is the most likely misconception?

Target word: misconception from error pattern **Decides:** In the ones place $2 - 7$ was treated as $7 - 2$.

A	Confusion set	$52 + 17 = 69$, not 45.
B	Camouflage	Answers the trip detail; the pattern is systematic.
C	Adjacent category	The facts used ($7 - 2$, $5 - 1$) are correct; the process is wrong.
D	Correct	$7 - 2 = 5$ in the ones and $5 - 1 = 4$ in the tens gives 45; the student avoided regrouping.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher knows most students misapply regrouping in subtraction. What is the best reteaching plan?

Target word: from misconception to action **Decides:** Target the idea with concrete models.

A	Inverted operation	Ignores the misconception.
B	Correct	Targets the specific misconception.
C	Dropped element	More practice repeats the error.
D	Absolute language	Most of the unit was understood.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A third-grade class is studying persuasive writing. The school is near a park where the swings were removed, ~~and the class loves a popular cartoon.~~ Which activity offers the most relevance?

Target word: authentic relevance **Decides:** Real purpose and audience.

A	Camouflage	Answers the cartoon detail; surface theme only.
B	Correct	Real purpose, real audience, and a local issue.
C	Dropped element	No real audience or purpose.
D	Adjacent category	Removes the real audience.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A fourth grader who arrived from another country last year speaks conversational English but struggles to write science explanations. ~~Her family owns a bakery, and she sits by the window.~~ What support fits best?

Target word: EL scaffold **Decides:** Keep the goal; support the language.

A	Camouflage	Answers the bakery detail; does not scaffold the science explanation.
B	Correct	Language supports give access to the same content goal.
C	Inverted operation	Lowers the content goal.
D	Absolute language	Drawing can help but should not replace building writing.

5. Answer C Concept 4

During state testing, a student teacher sees her cooperating teacher point to a correct answer for a struggling student. The cooperating teacher has been kind ~~and wrote her a strong letter of recommendation~~. The test was in the library. What should the student teacher do?

Target word: ethical dilemma response **Decides:** Testing integrity is a clear professional duty.

A	Adjacent category	Public confrontation during testing is not the proper channel.
B	Inverted operation	Tampering with a test is itself a violation.
C	Correct	Codes of ethics and testing rules come before personal loyalty.
D	Camouflage	Answers the loyalty detail; ignores the duty.

6. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A teacher is asked by a parent to change a grade the student did not earn, and the parent is on the school board. What principle decides the response?

Target word: reverse: grade integrity **Decides:** Grades must reflect actual performance.

A	Correct	Accurate records are an ethical duty.
B	Inverted operation	Emotion does not change the ethical duty.
C	Adjacent category	Position does not change grading integrity.
D	Absolute language	Discussing grades is fine; changing unearned ones is not.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A student teacher in her last month has been grading until midnight, skipping meals, and feels constantly tired. Her placement is ~~at a large school with a new gym~~. What is the healthiest next step?

Target word: self-care response **Decides:** Set boundaries and seek support.

A	Inverted operation	Swings to neglecting duties.
B	Absolute language	Unlimited hours lead to burnout.
C	Camouflage	Answers the gym detail; ignores workload.
D	Correct	Sustainable habits and early support protect effectiveness.

8. Answer C Concept 6

A new teacher's evaluation shows strong planning but low marks for questioning. She teaches third grade ~~and loves gardening~~. Which growth goal is best?

Target word: SMART growth goal **Decides:** Specific, measurable, tied to evidence, timed.

A	Camouflage	Answers the hobby detail; not tied to the evidence.
B	Dropped element	Not specific or measurable.
C	Correct	Specific, measurable, tied to evaluation evidence, with a timeline.
D	Inverted operation	Targets a strength, not the gap.

9. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A teacher's goal says: "Increase student discussion time." What must be added to make it measurable?

Target word: find what is missing **Decides:** Needs a measure and time.

A	Correct	Measurable goals state how much and by when.
B	Adjacent category	A rationale does not make a goal measurable.
C	Dropped element	Intensity words are not measures.
D	Absolute language	It lacks a target and timeline.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A student teacher learns about a new digital reading program at a conference and wants to replace all reading instruction with it tomorrow. ~~The program has great reviews online and a bright logo.~~ What is the wisest approach?

Target word: trying new methods **Decides:** Pilot small, measure, then decide.

A	Camouflage	Answers the reviews detail; no evidence from her class.
B	Absolute language	New methods should be explored carefully.
C	Correct	A small pilot with data shows whether it helps.
D	Dropped element	Drops the measure.

11. Answer D Concept 8

On an evaluation rubric, the top level for discussion says: "Students ask one another questions and build on each other's ideas." In a lesson ~~in a room with a new rug,~~ the student teacher asked every question and students answered her only. ~~She worked very hard on the lesson.~~ Which level is best supported?

Target word: match evidence to descriptor **Decides:** Students did not talk to each other.

A	Absolute language	Teacher questioning can meet lower levels.
B	Confusion set	Answering the teacher is not student-to-student discussion.
C	Camouflage	Effort does not match the descriptor.
D	Correct	The rating depends on the descriptor evidence.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A teacher wants to reach the top rubric level for discussion. Which change would provide that evidence?

Target word: reverse: what earns the level **Decides:** Student-to-student building.

A	Correct	Matches the descriptor.
B	Absolute language	Equal turns answering the teacher are still not student-to-student talk.
C	Adjacent category	Planning documents are not evidence of discussion.
D	Inverted operation	Keeps talk teacher-centered.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	8	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Error analysis of student work	Look for the pattern in wrong answers to find the misconception, then reteach that idea rather than simply reteaching the whole lesson.	Counting wrong answers without asking why they are wrong.	A set of student answers with the same kind of mistake.
2	Relevance through authentic purpose	Activities feel relevant when students do real work for a real audience or purpose connected to their lives and communities.	Believing relevance means adding a pop-culture theme to a worksheet.	Planning an activity to boost engagement and meaning.
3	Scaffolds for English learners	Sentence frames, visuals, word banks, and partner talk help English learners reach grade-level content without lowering the goal.	Giving English learners easier content or a different, simpler task.	A multilingual learner in a grade-level lesson.
4	Ethical decision-making with a code of ethics	When facing a dilemma, identify the duties in conflict, use the professional code of ethics and school policy, and choose the action that protects students and integrity.	Deciding by loyalty to a colleague or by what is easiest.	A colleague's action that may harm students or break testing or grading rules.
5	Sustainable self-care	Set work boundaries, keep routines that protect sleep and health, and seek support early; self-care supports effectiveness, not selfishness.	Believing good teachers work every evening and weekend without limit.	A new teacher showing signs of exhaustion.
6	A professional growth goal	A strong growth goal is specific, measurable, tied to evidence from evaluation or student data, and has a timeline and plan.	Writing vague goals like "become a better teacher."	Writing a goal for a growth plan or induction year.
7	Trying new materials and methods	Pilot a new method on a small scale with a clear measure of student learning, compare with prior results, then decide.	Adopting a new method for everything at once because it is popular.	A teacher excited about a new program or strategy.
8	Evidence and evaluation rubrics	A rating on a teaching rubric depends on evidence that matches the level's descriptor, often including what students do, not only what the teacher does.	Assuming effort or good intentions earn the top rating.	A self-rating or evaluation conference.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching II is the final part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. The course offers a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Student Teaching I, candidates receive ongoing feedback through observations and a final evaluation. This evaluation assesses activities' relevance and cultural engagement, the effectiveness of teaching each student, the ability to analyze and adjust teaching methods, and the willingness to explore new materials and methods. Successful completion of Student Teaching II is a crucial step in the licensure process, as it determines eligibility for licensure as a professional educator. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve

into professional development topics such as professional growth opportunities, ethical decision making, and self-care. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.